it. At the last minute I suggested a slightly asymmetric design that would cause the pin to seem to lean along with the G. I was instantly considered by the arts and crafts teacher to have an artistic talent, which was ludicrously wrong, of course. In any case, it was a success, and Gertrude wore the pin for years afterward.

We square danced, took tango lessons, and played Ping-Pong and charades. We had a good group for the last—the kind that could quickly work out "neutron-induced uranium fission."

I shone when we quickly discovered that out of a nine-word phrase the second word was "the" and the fourth word "river." I made the necessary intuitive leap and said, "And even the weariest river winds somewhere safe to sea," and created quite a stir in doing so.

On the last day, I learned the words and tune to all four verses of "Venezuela/' which is one of my favorites to this day. Add to this the fact that the food was good, copious, and frequent, even to regular midnight snacks, and I think it must rank the best resort vacation we ever had. I have always regretted that we only stayed a week.

We got back to Stuyvesant Town on August 22 to find that John Blugerman had been there the day before to bring in the mail and to check that everything was all right. (We had given him the keys for that purpose.)

He also left a note in which he rather hilariously paid tribute to my intelligence. It seemed that I had carefully guarded the apartment against burglary by putting our radio and typewriter in an unlocked closet, and doing other things of equal subtlety. I had made a careful list on a piece of paper of all the shrewd things I was going to do: "Place radio in hall closet. Place typewriter in linen closet under sheets." Then I had forgetfully left that piece of paper on the desk in plain view.

Fortunately, no burglar had entered to take advantage of the kind help I had offered him.

7

The weather had been beautiful at Chester's Zunbarg, with only one cloudy day. It was rather less than beautiful in New York. On August 25, a heat wave of nearly record proportions began. The average temperature, day and night, remained above 90 for three straight days, with highs of 98, 101, and 98, respectively.